

Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker

Team Nova Collaborative | UN SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth
WRITTEN SUMMARY — Problem, Solution & Implementation Plan (Final Submission Document)

1. Problem Statement

Freelancers and independent contractors frequently lack a centralized way to manage contracts, invoices, and payment milestones. Without organized records, gig workers face heightened risk of payment disputes and wage theft, and struggle to produce evidence when a dispute arises. This directly undermines fair and secure work — the core aim of UN SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth).

Research grounding: Gig and freelance work has grown rapidly, but the contractual protections and tooling available to traditional employees rarely extend to independent workers. Existing solutions are either generic file storage (no domain-specific structure) or full-scale freelance platforms (too heavy for independent use). This left a clear gap for a lightweight, purpose-built tracking tool.

2. Solution Summary

The **Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker** is an MVP web application that gives gig workers a secure, centralized system to manage their contracts and invoices, and to protect themselves with better documentation.

Core features delivered:

- **Secure contract storage and management** — upload and organize contract documents in one place
- **Automated invoicing** — generate and track invoices tied to contract milestones
- **Contract and invoice tracking** — visibility into payment status and outstanding milestones
- **User-facing dashboard** — a single view of active contracts, invoices, and payment state
- **Supporting UI/UX design** — user stories, wireframes, and user flow to guide the build

Scope decisions: The team deliberately narrowed an initially broader concept to this core feature set, deferring additional integrations (e.g. deeper payment automation, third-party platform integrations) to a backlog. This kept the MVP achievable within the project timeline while still directly addressing the central problem: giving gig workers a defensible record of their work and payment terms.

Notable technical resolution: During development, the team identified a bug in the AI-assisted contract-value extraction feature, traced to limitations in the static design and PDF-upload interpretation. This was diagnosed and fixed before final submission — an example of the team validating and correcting AI-generated output rather than shipping it uncritically.

3. Implementation Plan

Project management approach: The team ran this as a structured project rather than an ad hoc build, producing:

- Project Charter and Problem Statement / KPI framework
- Product Backlog and Sprint Backlog
- Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

- Stakeholder Analysis and Risk Register
- Team Communication and Meeting Plan, with a defined Project Schedule

Build sequence:

- Define problem, stakeholders, and success criteria (Charter, KPIs, stakeholder analysis)
- Scope and prioritize features into a backlog; break into sprints
- Design UX (user stories, wireframes, user flow) before development
- Build core features: contract storage, invoicing, tracking, dashboard
- Address security requirements identified during planning
- Test, triage, and resolve critical bugs (e.g. the AI extraction issue)
- Finalize documentation and publish the MVP

Risk management: The team tracked infrastructure risks (power and internet instability) and technical risks (an under-validated database/data layer) throughout, addressing the database gap late in development using Google AI Studio alongside the existing codebase and security requirements.

How to run/view the project: See the repository README for setup instructions and the linked recorded walkthrough (max 5 minutes).

4. Outcome

The team delivered a working, published MVP aligned with the original problem statement and SDG 8 goal, backed by a full set of planning and delivery documentation. Key next steps identified for a future iteration include completing database validation, structured end-to-end testing with realistic data, user acceptance testing with real gig workers, and a dedicated security review ahead of any public release.